“We’re second-class citizens, and we have politicians like [Foreign Minister Avigdor] Lieberman who think even that is too good,” said Faris Mahrous, an older Kafr Kanna resident who spent the week trying to calm the rioters. “And these boys see the crimes in Jerusalem, in the West Bank, in Gaza. What do you expect?”

The shooting drew comparisons to what Israelis call the “October 2000 events”, ten days of heavy rioting that ended with twelve Israeli Arabs and one resident of Gaza killed by the police. The protests, which coincided with the start of the Second Intifada, came immediately after Ariel Sharon’s controversial visit to the Temple Mount. (In Arabic the riots are known as *hibat October*, the “October outburst”.) A Jewish Israeli was also killed when a stone hit his car on the highway between Haifa and Tel Aviv.

A month later the government named a commission of inquiry to investigate the violence, led by Theodore Or, a former high court justice. The panel, known as the Or Commission, took nearly three years to publish its 800-page report; it ultimately laid blame on both the police, for their heavy-handed approach to the protests, and the leadership of the Arab community, for inciting them.

More significantly, though, the Or Commission also described the background to the riots—a clear acknowledgment that the Arab community had faced decades of official discrimination. “The state, and generations of governments, failed to deal in a thorough and comprehensive way with the serious problems that were created by the existence of a large Arab minority within a Jewish state,” the authors said in their executive summary. “The government’s handling of the Arab sector has been largely neglectful and discriminatory… the state has not done enough, and not made a sufficient effort, in order to create equality for its Arab citizens and to remove discrimination and injustice.”

The inequality goes far beyond interactions with the police. The employment rate for Arab men in 2015 was 75 per cent, compared to 86 per cent for Jewish men. (It was a meager 33 per cent for Arab women, but cultural norms deserve a share of the blame, not just discrimination.) More than half of Arab families live below the poverty line, twice the national rate. While Jewish schools have slightly fewer students per classroom than their Arab counterparts, they get vastly more money from the state: high schools receive at least a 35 per cent premium, according to 2013–14 data from the education ministry.